

Rent and Payments Policy

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Department:	Tenancy Services

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy sets out DataCompany Housing Management's requirements and expectations regarding the payment of rent and other tenancy-related charges. It applies to all residential tenants occupying properties managed by DataCompany in Harare, Zimbabwe and any other localities in which DataCompany operates. It covers standard monthly rent, service charges, utility contributions and any ancillary fees as defined in the individual Tenancy Agreement.

The policy aims to ensure financial sustainability of the housing portfolio, protect tenants from unfair charges, and set clear, transparent expectations for both parties from the commencement of a tenancy.

2. Rent Setting and Review

2.1 Initial Rent

Rent is set at the commencement of each tenancy based on a fair market assessment conducted by DataCompany's Property Valuation Team. The assessment considers property size, location, condition, local comparable rentals and current economic indicators. The agreed rent is documented in the Tenancy Agreement signed by both parties before occupation commences.

2.2 Annual Rent Review

DataCompany conducts an annual rent review for all tenancies. Tenants will receive a minimum of 90 days written notice of any proposed rent increase. The review is guided by the Zimbabwe Consumer Price Index (CPI), prevailing market rates and the condition and improvements made to the property. Increases shall not exceed 15% per annum without written agreement from both parties.

- Rent review notices are issued in writing via registered mail or the DataCompany tenant portal.
- Tenants may request a review of the proposed increase within 30 days of receipt of notice.
- Where a dispute arises, the matter is referred to the Complaints and Dispute Resolution process (DC-POL-009).
- DataCompany will not impose mid-tenancy increases outside of the scheduled annual review except in exceptional circumstances agreed in writing.

3. Payment Methods and Due Dates

3.1 Due Dates

Rent is due on the 1st day of each calendar month (the 'due date'). Where the 1st falls on a public holiday or weekend, payment must reach DataCompany's account no later than the last working day before that date. It is the tenant's responsibility to ensure timely payment regardless of banking or public holidays.

3.2 Accepted Payment Methods

Payment Method	Reference Required	Processing Time
EcoCash Mobile Money	Tenant Account Number	Same day
Bank Transfer (ZIPIT)	Tenant Account Number	1 business day
Direct Debit (Standing Order)	Set up via portal	Automatic on due date
Cash (DataCompany Offices)	Official receipt issued	Same day
Cheque (approved tenants only)	Payable to DataCompany Ltd	3-5 business days

Tenants are strongly encouraged to set up a standing order or use the DataCompany tenant portal at portal.datacompany.co.zw to make and track payments. Cash payments must be made in person at our Harare offices; DataCompany does not accept cash collected by any individual representative.

4. Late Payment and Arrears

4.1 Grace Period

A grace period of five (5) calendar days from the due date is granted for rent payment. Payment received after the 5th day of the month is considered late. DataCompany does not charge a late fee during the grace period provided the tenant has not incurred late payment in the preceding three months.

4.2 Late Payment Charges

Days Overdue	Action Taken	Applicable Charge
6-14 days	First written reminder issued	Administrative fee: USD 10
15-30 days	Second notice, arrears meeting offered	Late charge: 5% of monthly rent
31-60 days	Formal Notice to Remedy issued	Late charge: 10% of monthly rent
61-90 days	Final Notice; legal action initiated	Full arrears + legal costs
90+ days	Eviction proceedings commenced	Refer to DC-POL-010

Tenants experiencing financial difficulty are encouraged to contact DataCompany Tenancy Services at the earliest opportunity. Payment plans may be arranged at the discretion of the Housing Manager, provided the tenant demonstrates good faith and maintains agreed installments.

5. Service Charges and Additional Fees

In addition to base rent, certain properties attract service charges covering shared maintenance, security, gardens and communal utilities. These charges are disclosed in the Tenancy Agreement and reviewed annually alongside rent. The following table summarises standard additional charges:

Charge Type	Description	Amount / Basis
Communal Maintenance Levy	Upkeep of shared areas, gardens, lighting	USD 15-40/month depending on property type

Water and Sanitation Contribution	Where not separately metered	USD 10-25/month (usage-adjusted)
Security Levy	24-hour perimeter security where applicable	USD 20/month
Administration Fee (annual)	Tenancy renewal, documentation	USD 25 per renewal
Key Replacement	Loss of issued keys or access fobs	USD 15 per key / USD 30 per fob
Bounced Payment Charge	Returned EFT or dishonoured cheque	USD 20 per occurrence

6. Rent Receipts and Records

DataCompany issues a rent receipt or payment confirmation within 48 hours of each payment received. Receipts are available on the tenant portal and may be emailed on request. Tenants are advised to retain all receipts for the duration of their tenancy and for a minimum of 12 months following the end of tenancy.

- All payment records are maintained on the DataCompany property management system.
- Tenants may request a full payment statement at any time via info@datacompany.co.zw.
- Discrepancies must be reported within 14 days of the statement date.
- DataCompany will not accept claims for payments not supported by official receipts.

7. Policy Compliance and Review

This policy is reviewed annually by the Head of Housing Operations or following any significant change in applicable legislation, such as amendments to the Zimbabwe Rent (Control) Act. Non-compliance by tenants may result in action under the Eviction and Legal Action Policy (DC-POL-010). Questions regarding this policy should be directed to Tenancy Services on +263 4 700 100 or info@datacompany.co.zw.